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Bucky Qian
Applied AI Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Applied AI Engineer with 4+ years of experience shipping production software at Apple and a venture-backed AI startup. Built **LLM-powered products** at Topify AI spanning **prompt tracking**, **citation monitoring**, **multi-step LLM workflows**, and **real-time streaming interfaces** using TypeScript, React, Next.js, and Server-Sent Events. Hands-on experience building **AI agents**, **RAG pipelines**, **tool-calling workflows**, **structured outputs**, **embeddings**, **vector search**, and **LLM evaluation** with OpenAI APIs, TypeScript, and Python. Earlier at Apple, shipped **AI-powered chat and recommendation experiences** on internal platforms supporting global operations. Strongest at turning LLM capabilities into reliable production products through prompt tooling, retrieval, evaluation, observability, and data-driven iteration.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI / LLM	OpenAI API, AI Agents, RAG, Prompt Engineering, Tool Calling, Structured Outputs, Multi-Step LLM Workflows, Streaming AI Interfaces
Retrieval / Evaluation	Embeddings, Vector Search, Semantic Retrieval, ChromaDB, Top-K Retrieval, Precision@K, Recall@K, LLM-as-Judge
Languages	TypeScript, JavaScript, Python
Frontend	React, Next.js, Vue 2/3, Tailwind CSS, HTML5, CSS3, WCAG 2.1 AA
Backend / APIs	Node.js, REST APIs, Server-Sent Events (SSE), WebSockets
Product / Tooling	PostHog, Funnel Analysis, A/B Testing, Stripe, OpenAI Agents SDK, Zod, Vercel, GitHub Actions, Jest, Cypress, Playwright

EXPERIENCE

Topify AI	Nov 2025 — Aug 2026
Frontend Engineer	San Francisco, CA

AI-powered SaaS for **LLM visibility**, prompt analysis, citation monitoring, and generative search optimization; partnered directly with founders from product definition through launch and iteration.

- Owned end-to-end development of **LLM-powered product workflows** spanning prompt tracking, citation monitoring across generative search engines, competitor analysis, and AI-generated reporting using **TypeScript**, **React**, and **Next.js**.
- Built **real-time streaming AI interfaces** with **Server-Sent Events (SSE)**, progressively delivering prompts, answers, citations, competitor insights, sentiment, and analysis results as **multi-step LLM workflows** executed.
- Built internal tooling for **prompt management**, cross-provider model tracking, and operational debugging, supporting the feedback loop used to monitor **AI output quality** and iterate on prompts.
- Instrumented **PostHog** analytics and conversion funnels across signup, onboarding, analysis generation, and purchase flows; used drop-off data to guide product and UX iteration.
- Integrated **Stripe** subscription billing, trials, coupons, referral attribution, and self-service payment workflows.
- Improved frontend performance, accessibility, and SEO across product and marketing applications.

Core Services team building and scaling internal web platforms supporting global Apple operations.

- Designed and shipped **AI-powered chat and recommendation experiences**, improving content discoverability and increasing self-service support efficiency by **25%**.
- Led accessibility initiatives across multiple internal platforms, achieving **WCAG 2.1 AA** compliance and reducing post-release accessibility defects by **80%**; established reusable accessibility standards adopted across teams.
- Led migration from **Vue 2 to Vue 3** and transitioned build systems from **Webpack to Vite**, improving developer iteration speed by **40%**.
- Reduced initial page load times by **30%** through lazy loading, code splitting, asset prefetching, and CI/CD automation.

EDUCATION

Master of Information Studies in Technology, <i>Trine University</i>	Aug 2025
Bachelor of Computer Science, <i>University of California, Santa Cruz</i>	2021
Associate’s Degree in Math and Computer Science, <i>College of San Mateo</i>	2019